

BOOSTING PERFORMANCE

It's easy to tweak the performance of Windows XP further. All you need to do is follow these instructions

Group Policy Editor
Microsoft bundles a nifty utility (only in the

hand side, you will find options to change the settings for this program. Click

all update features'. Windows will not prompt you to update now and you cannot update manually from the Web site either.

Removing unnecessary options from Task Manager

If you want to remove some options from the Task Manager, navigate to **User configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > System > Ctrl+Alt+Del option**. In the right-hand pane disable any option that says 'Remove logoff' by checking it.

Customising IE interface

Tired of the same old IE interface? Customise by going to **User configuration > Internet Explorer Maintenance > Browser User Interface**. Change the browser title name and manually add the name you want to see on the browser. You can even add a customised animated logo and change the background of the toolbar by going to 'Browser toolbar customisation'.

Disable list of startup programs

Want to disable the list of startup programs? Go to **User Configuration > Administrative Templates > System > Logon** and enable 'Do not process the run once list'. This prevents programs from start-



Remove Burn

XP provides a software for burning. But if you don't have a CD-Writer, disable it by going to **User configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Explorer**. Enable the 'Remove CD burning features' option.

ing up automatically, thus giving you a faster boot up time.

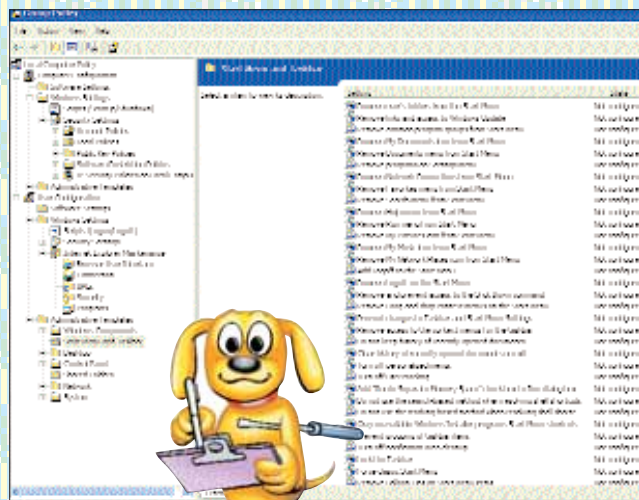
Removing inactive icons from system tray

XP hides inactive icons in the system tray by default. In order to remove this facility completely, you will have to navigate to **User configuration > Administrative templates > Start menu and Taskbar**. On the right-hand side, scroll down to 'Turn off notification area clean up'. Now your icons cannot be hidden at all.



Disk Management

You can create, delete or rename your partitions in Windows XP. Go to **Control Panel > Performance and Maintenance > Administrative Tools > Computer Management**. You will now be able to access the Disk Management program. Right-click on the hard disk partition and rename or delete it.



Professional Edition) which allows you to change almost every setting of the OS without having to manually edit the registry. In order to access the program go to **Start > Run** and type **gpedit.msc**.

Now you can navigate and change the options as you wish. We have some examples here, but you can also try changing other settings.

Disabling MSN Messenger from starting automatically

Navigate to **User configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Messenger**. On the right-

The Group Policy Editor allows tuning XP for perfection

on 'Do not automatically start windows messenger initially' and enable this rule to prevent starting MSN Messenger when you start Windows. This would lessen your boot up time and also save memory.

Disabling Windows update

If you wish to remove the Windows update option, go to **User Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Update**. You can completely remove this option by enabling 'Remove access to

